

FAQs

Mysterious file

Q I have a 15 GB hard disk. On my drive C, there is a file named win386.swp that takes 60 MB of space. I want to delete this file, but whenever I try deleting it, I get an error message. I even tried deleting it by starting the PC in DOS and in the Safe Mode. Although it gets deleted then, it reappears when Windows starts. Please tell me what to do.

Varun Kumar Arya

Via e-mail

A This is the Windows swap file. Windows uses this file to temporarily hold data when it finds the RAM to be insufficient. With the kind of applications we run on our computers everyday, it



Turn off Virtual Memory in Windows 98

would be virtually impossible for your PC to run smoothly without this. The file is always opened by Windows for reading and writing, thus you cannot delete it. Though you could disable virtual memory from **Control Panel > System > Performance > Virtual Memory** and remove the file, this is not recommended.

Hard disk not detected

Q I have an ASUS P2B motherboard with a Pentium II 400 MHz processor and 128 MB RAM. I changed the hard disk to a Seagate 40 GB 7200 rpm. Now the BIOS does not recognise the hard disk, but it works well on other systems.

Please help me solve the problem.

Arul

Via e-mail

A Your motherboard is quite old and you will have to update its BIOS for it to detect any hard disk upwards of 37 GB. You can download the BIOS update utility from ftp://ftp.asuscom.de/pub/ASUSCOM/BIOS/BIOS_FLASH_UTILS/af1ash206.zip and the BIOS patch from <ftp://ftp.asuscom.de/pub/ASUSCO>

M/BIOS/Slot_1/INTEL_Chipset/i440 BX/P2B/with_Hardwaremonitor/1014_02.zip. Remember to take a backup of the BIOS before updating it. (For more instructions, refer to Digit, June 2002 issue.)

CD-RW maintenance

Q I recently purchased a Sony CD-Writer (24x-10x-40x) and want to know if the lens for reading and writing is the same. I am told that if I use the drive for reading, it shortens its life. Is this true?

Manish Katiyar

Via e-mail

A Yes, the same lens is used for reading and writing on this drive. There is no need to worry though; this will not affect the expected life of your writer.

A This is quite a common problem that occurs with an updated version of Windows Installer, the tool Microsoft introduced for software installation and maintenance. A complete uninstall and re-install of Office will help. One Microsoft article suggests that you may be using a beta or unlicensed version of Office XP that cannot be upgraded to SP1—you might need to purchase an authentic box packed version.

Web server setup

Q I am a freelance software developer. My current project is a Web-based application using ASP/JSP. I plan to use Linux and MySQL in the near future and I expect approximately 10,000 transactions per day with 300 concurrent users. Is MySQL stable enough for this requirement? What can it scale to? Which is the best Linux flavour for this? Is ASP supported on Linux?

What is the ideal hardware configuration for the server and clients?

Selvakumaran

Via e-mail

A MySQL should hold up to your specifications, but whether it really does and what it scales to depends entirely on the database design, the number of tables, the number of fields, the types of queries, the joins used, etc. Without such information, any estimate on reliability would be vague. Debian is a very stable Linux distribution, but Red Hat is the most popular flavour for the Internet and also has more support. You can deploy ASP applications using the Apache, iPlanet or Zeus Web servers with Sun ChiliSoft ASP found at www.chilisoft.com. However, there is no deployment solution for ASP better than IIS (Internet Information Server)—you may lose out on

performance and even miss a few methods and functions while working with third-party tools such as these. You can use any standard server configuration; a 700 MHz processor with 256 MB RAM should work, though you should consider throwing in as much RAM as your budget will allow.

System File Checker

Q My PC runs on Windows 98. Whenever I start System File Checker, I get the message: 'SFC cannot check the following folder because the volume is locked: c:\windows\system\macromed\shock7. Close all other programs and click Retry to check this folder again. Click Cancel to stop checking files.' How do I remedy this?

Rohit

Via e-mail

A Close all programs before running SFC—press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del] to bring up the task list. End all tasks except Explorer and Systray. If the error still shows, browse to the folder in the error message from Windows Explorer and check its properties. All attributes should be unchecked. If it's already so, reboot the machine and hold down the [Ctrl] key while booting. Choose Command Prompt Only from the Startup menu. Run a thorough scandisk on drive C and fix all errors.

If the problem still persists, move the Shock7 folder outside the Windows folder. You can re-install the latest version of Shockwave from www.macromedia.com.



Send your problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706